AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION/MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT

1. CONTRACT ID CODE	PAGE	OF	PAGES
	1		1

2. AMENDMENT/MODIFICATION NUMBER	3. EFFECTIVE DATE	4. REQUISITION/PURCHASE REQUISITION NUMBER	5. PROJECT NUMBER *(If applicable)*
040ADV-26-R-0002-C0001			

6. ISSUED BY	CODE	GPO	7. ADMINISTERED BY *(If other than Item 6)*	CODE	GPO
GPO 732 North Capitol St NW Washington, DC, 20401, US			Same As Issuing Office		

8. NAME AND ADDRESS OF CONTRACTOR *(Number, street, county, State and ZIP Code)*	(X)	9A. AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION NUMBER
	☒	040ADV-26-R-0002
		9B. DATED *(SEE ITEM 11)* 10/28/2025
	☐	10A. MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT/ORDER NUMBER
		10B. DATED *(SEE ITEM 13)*
CODE / FACILITY CODE		

11. THIS ITEM ONLY APPLIES TO AMENDMENTS OF SOLICITATIONS

☒ The above numbered solicitation is amended as set forth in Item 14. The hour and date specified for receipt of Offers ☒ is extended. ☐ is not extended.

Offers must acknowledge receipt of this amendment prior to the hour and date specified in the solicitation or as amended, by one of the following methods: (a) By completing items 8 and 15, and returning _____ copies of the amendment; (b) By acknowledging receipt of this amendment on each copy of the offer submitted; or (c) By separate letter or electronic communication which includes a reference to the solicitation and amendment numbers. FAILURE OF YOUR ACKNOWLEDGMENT TO BE RECEIVED AT THE PLACE DESIGNATED FOR THE RECEIPT OF OFFERS PRIOR TO THE HOUR AND DATE SPECIFIED MAY RESULT IN REJECTION OF YOUR OFFER. If by virtue of this amendment you desire to change an offer already submitted, such change may be made by letter or electronic communication, provided each letter or electronic communication makes reference to the solicitation and this amendment, and is received prior to the opening hour and date specified.

12. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA *(If required)*

13. THIS ITEM APPLIES ONLY TO MODIFICATIONS OF CONTRACTS/ORDERS. IT MODIFIES THE CONTRACT/ORDER NUMBER AS DESCRIBED IN ITEM 14.

CHECK ONE	
☐	A. THIS CHANGE ORDER IS ISSUED PURSUANT TO: *(Specify authority)* THE CHANGES SET FORTH IN ITEM 14 ARE MADE IN THE CONTRACT ORDER NUMBER IN ITEM 10A.
☐	B. THE ABOVE NUMBERED CONTRACT/ORDER IS MODIFIED TO REFLECT THE ADMINISTRATIVE CHANGES *(such as changes in paying office, appropriation data, etc.)* SET FORTH IN ITEM 14, PURSUANT TO THE AUTHORITY OF FAR 43.103(b).
☐	C. THIS SUPPLEMENTAL AGREEMENT IS ENTERED INTO PURSUANT TO AUTHORITY OF:
☐	D. OTHER *(Specify type of modification and authority)*

E. IMPORTANT: Contractor ☐ is not ☐ is required to sign this document and return _____ copies to the issuing office.

14. DESCRIPTION OF AMENDMENT/MODIFICATION (*Organized by UCF section headings, including solicitation/contract subject matter where feasible.)*

AMENDMENT CONTROL NUMBER : 040ADV-26-R-0002

SUMMARY OF CHANGES : The purpose of this amendment is to:

1) Extend the proposal due date to November 14, 2025 at 4:00 pm local time; and

2) Incorporate the solicitation Q&A.

Except as provided herein, all terms and conditions of the document referenced in Item 9A or 10A, as heretofore changed, remains unchanged and in full force and effect.

15A. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER *(Type or print)*		16A. NAME AND TITLE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER *(Type or print)*	
15B. CONTRACTOR/OFFEROR *(Signature of person authorized to sign)*	15C. DATE SIGNED	16B. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA *(Signature of Contracting Officer)*	16C. DATE SIGNED

Q & A - RFP 040ADV-26-R-0002

FY26 SQL/ORACLE DBA SUPPORT

Q1. Can we request the name of the incumbent vendor and their contract number, considering they are currently under performing?

A1. The incumbent contractor is GENCO SYSTEMS INC., Award # 040ADV-24-F-0068. POP: 01-Oct-2024 to 31-Dec-2025

Q2. What is the total award value of the ongoing contract held by the incumbent vendor?

A2. The total contract value is $885,600.00

Q3. Is there an incumbent?

A3. Yes, see A1, A2

Q4. If yes, what is the incumbent's name, contract number, award amount and duration?

A4. See A1, A2

Q5. Are resumes required?

A5. Yes, resumes are required

Q6. Please confirm if this is a new requirement or if there is an incumbent contractor currently providing these services.

A6. See A1, A2

Q7. Section 5.0 mentions that "Support personnel will deliver a weekly report at the end of each work week." Apart from the four full-time DBA resources, are we allowed to propose additional support personnel (e.g., a Project Manager) after contract award, or should we include such personnel and their resumes in the initial submission?

A7. No. The additional personnel are not required.

Q8. Please confirm that the requirement is strictly for four (4) full-time Database Administrators — two (2) Senior Oracle DBAs and two (2) Senior SQL DBAs.

A8. Yes.

Q9. Are actual resumes required for proposed resources, or will representative/sample resumes be acceptable at the proposal submission stage?

A9. Resume of the proposed resources are required.

Q10. The “Place of Performance” section notes both remote and on-site options. Could you clarify whether this will be a hybrid setup and, if so, the expected frequency of onsite presence at the GPO office?

A10. Work will be performed remotely per GPO’s IT Security policy and regulations.

Q11. If onsite work or travel to the D.C. office is required, will travel costs be reimbursed or should they be built into the fixed price?

A11. GPO is not responsible for travel cost.

Q12. Should pricing be limited to the line items identified in Section B only?

A12. Offeror is required to submit a detail cost proposal/spreadsheet along with the CLIN structure in Section B.

Q13. Please confirm if pricing should be submitted strictly in the format outlined in Section B and specify whether the submission should be provided in Excel or Word format.

A13. See A12

Q14. Is subcontracting permitted under this solicitation? If so, are there any small business subcontracting goals or participation requirements?

A14. No. Subcontracting is not permitted under this solicitation.

Q15. Section L.4 notes that “the list of past performance references, questionnaires, resumes, and table of content do not count toward the 30-page count.” Could you clarify what “questionnaires” refers to — is this the Past Performance Questionnaire provided in Attachment J.1?

A15. In addition to the Past Performance Questionnaire provided in Attachment J.1, Offeror is required to provide three (3) list of past performance references, per L.4 PROPOSAL SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS.

Q16. Please confirm that vendor references will be submitted directly by the offeror as part of the proposal package.

A16. Yes. Vendor references will be submitted directly by the offeror as part of the proposal package.

Q17. Regarding SF 1449, should the completed and signed form be included with the proposal submission, or will it be required post-award? If included, should it be a separate PDF or part of the technical volume?

A17. The signed cover page of SF 1449 should be included with the proposal submission.

Q18. Under Factor #2 (SME Qualifications), are the listed qualifications the only minimum requirements for proposed candidates? these qualifications will be same for both SQL and Oracle resources, or are there role-specific expectations?

A18. The listed qualifications are the minimum requirements for both SQL and Oracle resources.

Q19. Under Factor #1 (Corporate Experience / Technical Capabilities), may we use the same contracts for both "successful projects" and "past performance references," or must these be different examples?

A19. Yes, you may use the same contracts for both "successful projects" and "past performance references.

Q20. If a proposed SME becomes unavailable post-submission, what is the procedure for substitution before or after award?

A20. If the proposed SME becomes unavailable post-submission, you must notify GPO immediately, through the email provided on the cover page of the RFP, along with the new proposed substitution resume.

Q21. Are there any file size or naming conventions to be followed? Should the response be submitted in a single email or multiple emails? Please confirm.

A21. File size not to exceed 2MB. Offeror may submit multiples email with a clear subject line and # of email.

Q22. Could you please confirm whether these questionnaires should be submitted directly to the Contracting Officer by the references completing them, or if they should be transmitted by the offeror as part of the proposal package?

A22. Past Performance Questionnaire provided in Attachment J. 1 should be submitted by the offeror as part of the proposal package.

Q23. Is subcontracting and/or teaming permissible?

A23. No

Q24. Will the government provide necessary equipment and software for offsite support?

A24. A GPO laptop and RSA secure ID will be provided for support activities.

Q25. At what frequency is it expected for offsite personnel supporting this contract to visit GPO facilities?

A25. All works perform offsite

Q26. Is business related travel in connection to this contract reimbursable to the government?

A26. See A11

Q26. Is this a new opportunity or Rework?

A26. See A1, A2

Q27. If rework, who is the incumbent, and can the Govt. share the Contractor Name, Contract Number and Contract Value?

A27. See A1, A2

Q28. Are Incumbents eligible to Rebid?

A28. Yes

Q29. Is there an incumbent contractor currently performing this work? If so, will there be a transition period?

A29. Yes.

Q30. Any challenges or Pain points?

A30. No

Q31. What is the estimated award date?

A31. January 01, 2026

Q32. What is the maximum ceiling value?

A32. Information is not available

Q33. Can the Govt. provide any Wage determination?

A33. GSA rate with applicable discount

Q34. How often, if at all, will onsite presence at the GPO Central Office be required for personnel under this contract?

A34. See A25

Q35. Can we replace the candidates after the award?

A35. Yes. However, resume and qualification must be met after review and approval by GPO.

Q36. Are Key Personnel (the 4 DBAs) substitutable during the contract period, and if so, what approval process is required?

A36. Yes. Submit the request for substitution and resumes for review and approval by GPO

Q37. What are the annual Hours? Is it 1920 or 2080?

A37. 2080

Q38. Section C, the requirement states "Four DBAs will be needed (2 Senior SQL DBAs and 2 Senior Oracle DBAs)." Are all four positions required to be full-time equivalents (FTEs) or can they be part-time/as-needed?

A38. All 4 DBAs are full time

Q39. Section C, what are the expected service level agreements (SLAs) for response time and resolution time for database issues?

A39. SLAs are determined per issue. All requests are made via GPO Helpdesk and passed to the appropriate DBA support personnel. Response to an issue is expected within a couple of hours. Solutions, depending on the issue, may require more time as needed. This will be communicated to the affected business area POC by the DBA.

Q40. Section C, are there specific database versions the SMEs must be proficient in (e.g., SQL Server 2019/2022, Oracle 19c/21c)?

A40. Yes, the very latest versions of MS SQL and Oracle as well as previous versions that may be slated for upgrades.

Q41. Section C, weekly support activity reports are required - what format and level of detail is expected for these reports?

A41. Word or Adobe document delivered by weeks end with support activities (e.g., user support, upgrades, builds, etc.). No required length or format, just support or database dev activities.

Q42. Section C, the SOW states "Support timeframes are to be negotiated per request." Does this mean response times are not pre-defined, or should offerors propose standard SLAs?

A42. Response times are not pre-defined. Support timeframes are per support activity and to be discussed with business area POCs and IT management as necessary.

Q43. 6.0 Government-Furnished Equipment and Information. The SOW mentions "after hours activities (patching, server reboots, server support activities) should be expected periodically." What is the estimated frequency of after-hours work?

A43. As needed. This will all be scheduled in advance and coordinated with GPO infrastructure teams and business area POCs.

Q44. Section L.4, Is after-hours work included in the base FFP pricing, or will it be compensated separately? Should offerors include estimated after-hours work in their pricing?

A44. Comp time will be approved for the after-hours work, if it occurs.

Q45. 7.0 Place of Performance, the SOW states work can be performed remotely or onsite. Is there a minimum number of days required onsite? What are the expectations for physical presence?

A45. See A25

Q46. 7.0 Place of Performance. For remote work, will the contractor need to comply with specific GPO IT Security policies? Are there VPN or secure access requirements beyond the RSA token?

A46. Yes, contractor will need to comply with GPO IT Security policies. There is no access outside of VPN/RSA except when reporting to a GPO location onsite.

Q47. 9.0 Security. The SOW states work is "UNCLASSIFIED and CONFIDENTIAL." Does this require personnel to have security clearances? If so, what level?

A47. Public Trust. All contractors will be vetted by GPO Personnel Security.

Q48. Section B shows pricing for 12 months per line item, but the base period in Section F is only 9 months. Should offerors price the base year as 9 or 12 months?

A48. The Offerors prices the base year for 9 months

Q49. Section L.4 mentions that each past performance reference should include phone numbers and email addresses for at least two points of contact. Is it mandatory to provide two contacts per reference, or will one point of contact be acceptable?

A49. Two contacts per reference is mandatory.

Q50. The SOW states "The United States Government Printing Office (GPO) has a wealth of server-based applications." How many total SQL and Oracle databases are currently in production? Please provide a breakdown by type (standalone SQL, Oracle, SQL Cluster, MySQL, MariaDB, MS Access).

A50. See A89

Q51. What is the approximate total data volume (in TB or GB) stored across all SQL and Oracle databases combined? Are there separate development, test, staging, and production environments, and if so, what are the approximate sizes for each?

A51. Production: 12TB, DEV: 5TB, Staging: 500GB

Q52. How many database servers are currently in the GPO infrastructure? Please specify: (a) number of SQL Server instances, (b) number of Oracle database instances, (c) number of MS Access databases, (d) number of SQL Cluster nodes.

A52. 61 MSSQL Instances, 5 SQL Always ON Cluster.

Q53. What is the estimated number of users/applications accessing these databases daily? Are there peak usage times that require additional DBA support?

A53. 15 to 20 users daily leverage the SQL Servers. Additional DBA support is needed doing Application upgrade\Migrations\Patching\Script Execution

Q53. The SOW references "SQL Cluster environment" - can you provide technical specifications including: (a) number of nodes in the cluster, (b) failover configuration, (c) storage capacity, (d) current cluster utilization percentage?

A53. We have 5 SQL Always ON clusters that most of GPO APPS reside on. The Clusters are 2 nodes and setup for auto failover doing incidents. Each cluster holds about 1TB of data currently.

Q54. What are the current hardware specifications for the database servers (CPU, RAM, storage type/capacity, virtualized vs. physical, cloud vs. on-premises)? Are there planned infrastructure upgrades or cloud migrations?

A54. Windows Server 2019 R2 ,128GB Ram, Intel(R) Xenon(R) CPU 2.4GH

Q55. For the SQL/Oracle database support requirement, what are the current: (a) average monthly number of support tickets/requests, (b) average ticket resolution time, (c) distribution between routine maintenance vs. emergency issues?

A55. A – This varies from week to week however support personnel are not overrun with ticket requests. B - See A39. C – Not quite sure what this is asking. Emergencies are handled as emergencies with the highest priority. There are more routine than emergency.

Q56. The SOW mentions ""FootPrints requests related to GBIS"" - can you clarify: (a) what GBIS system is, (b) how many FootPrints requests are typically received per week/month, (c) what types of database changes GBIS requests typically involve?

S56. GBIS is GPOs internal Oracle suite of applications. FootPrints has been replace with Service Now and is GPOs problem and request tracking system.

Q57. What specific database versions are currently in production? Please provide: (a) SQL Server versions (2012, 2016, 2019, 2022, etc.), (b) Oracle versions (11g, 12c, 19c, 21c, etc.), (c) MySQL/MariaDB versions if applicable, (d) MS Access versions in use?

A57. All the above for SQL server versions, Oracle (19c), MS Access (legacy versions used in a few locations)

Q57. Does the current SQL/Oracle environment include: (a) SQL Server Always-On Availability Groups or other High Availability configurations, (b) Oracle Data Guard or Real Application Clusters (RAC), (c) automated backup systems, (d) disaster recovery sites?

A57. Yes, all clusters are configured with Availability Groups in a SQL Server AlwaysON install. User\Apps make connections using Listener.

Q58. What are the current backup and recovery requirements? Specifically: (a) backup frequency (hourly, daily, weekly), (b) Recovery Time Objective (RTO), (c) Recovery Point Objective (RPO), (d) backup storage location/strategy?

A58. Weekly Full Backups, Once a week on Fridays. Daily Differential Backups every day at 10PM. Transaction Log backups every 1hour. Backups are stored on local attached storage. RPO: 0

Q59. Are there specific performance/capacity thresholds that trigger alerts for DBA intervention (e.g., CPU usage >80%, disk space <20% available, query execution time >X seconds)? What are these thresholds?

A59. We leverage SQL Diagnostic Manager for managing Server resources and alerts. We get alerted once threshold is 80%>

Q60. The SOW states support for ""SQL Server, Oracle, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, and MS Access."" Of these technologies, which are currently: (a) in production, (b) in development/test, (c) planned for future use, (d) legacy/being phased out?

A60. All in use

Q61. Are there specific Service Level Agreements (SLAs) currently in place for database availability and performance? For example: (a) database availability target (e.g., 99.9%), (b) response time targets for different issue severity levels, (c) change window restrictions?

A61. See A39.

Q62. How many database-related change requests (RFCs) are typically processed per month? What percentage require emergency/off-hours implementation vs. scheduled maintenance windows?

A62. See A55.

Q63. The RFP does not mention documentation or knowledge base maintenance. Are DBAs expected to: (a) maintain current database architecture documentation, (b) create/update runbooks and troubleshooting guides, (c) document system configurations and changes?

A63. a Yes, b As necessary, c Yes.

Q64. What monitoring and management tools are currently deployed for SQL/Oracle database administration? (e.g., SQL Server Management Studio, Oracle Enterprise Manager, third-party tools like SolarWinds, Redgate, etc.)?

A64. SolarWinds and Idera SQL Diagnostic Manager

Q65. Are there any known performance issues, bottlenecks, or recurring problems with the current database infrastructure that the new contractor should be aware of?

A65. No.

Q66. Will the contractor have direct access to the GPO data center(s)/infrastructure, or is access restricted? What are the protocols for accessing database servers and performing maintenance?

A66. Yes, via server administrator accounts.

Q67. The SOW mentions work can be performed ""remotely or onsite"" but requires core business hours (7:30am-6:00pm). Are there specific business continuity or on-call requirements? For example, who handles database issues outside core business hours?

A67. The contractor will be required to handle emergency issues outside of core business hours. This is a rare occurrence.

Q68. How many database-related change requests (RFCs) are typically processed per month? What percentage require emergency/off-hours implementation vs. scheduled maintenance windows?

A68 See A55.

Q69. The RFP does not mention documentation or knowledge base maintenance. Are DBAs expected to: (a) maintain current database architecture documentation, (b) create/update runbooks and troubleshooting guides, (c) document system configurations and changes?

A69. See A63

Q70. What monitoring and management tools are currently deployed for SQL/Oracle database administration? (e.g., SQL Server Management Studio, Oracle Enterprise Manager, third-party tools like SolarWinds, Redgate, etc.)?

A70. See A4

Q71. Are there any known performance issues, bottlenecks, or recurring problems with the current database infrastructure that the new contractor should be aware of?

A71. No

Q72. Will the contractor have direct access to the GPO data center(s)/infrastructure, or is access restricted? What are the protocols for accessing database servers and performing maintenance?

A72. See A66.

Q73. 8.0 Period of Performance. For the option years (October 1 - September 30 for full 12-month periods), how many federal holidays fall within each option year? Should pricing be uniform across all 12-month option years?

A73. See A37

Q74. What is GPO's policy on Paid Time Off (PTO)/leave for contractor personnel? Is there a standard allocation (e.g., 15-20 days/year)? Should contractor pricing assume typical industry PTO levels?

A74. Personnel are required to follows the contractor’s internal personnel policy on PTO.

Q75. Due to the ongoing government funding uncertainty and potential shutdown-related staffing limitations, will GPO accept CPARs or narrative past performance summaries in

lieu of signed Past Performance Questionnaires if references are unable to respond by the proposal due date?

A75. Yes. See past performance instruction on page 14

Q76. The RFP states proposals must be submitted "in the GSA website and via email to sprak@gpo.gov." Can you confirm whether both submissions are required, or if submission through GSA (e.g., eBuy) alone is sufficient for compliance?

A76. Both submissions are required.

Q78. The SOW references four DBAs but does not explicitly identify which positions are "key personnel."

A78. All four (4) full-time database administrators are key personnel.

Q79. Can GPO confirm whether all four DBA positions are considered key and must include resumes?

A79. Yes. Resume are required for all four key personnel.

Q80. Please confirm that attachments (such as past performance questionnaires, resumes, and SF 1449) are excluded from the 30-page limit for the technical proposal.

A80. Yes. See Section L.4

Q81. Could you please confirm whether there is an incumbent contractor currently performing this requirement? If so, please provide the name of the incumbent vendor, the current contract number, and the period of performance for the existing contract.

A81. See A1, A2

Q82. Who is the incumbent? What is the current contract number?

A82. See A1, A2

Q83. Section M2 – Factor # 2 – Subject Matter Experts (SME) Qualifications, Page 16. Can the Government confirm that resumes are required for all four (4) database administrator positions, two (2) Oracle and two (2) SQL?

A83. See A79.

Q84. Can the Government confirm if Database servers are hosted in On Prem Servers or Cloud?

A84. Both

Q85. Can the Government clarify the version of Database servers that require support?

A85. See A40.

Q86. Section L.4 – Volume II – Price Proposal, Page 14. In addition to the completed CLIN structure in Section B, please confirm that we are allowed to submit a breakdown of the pricing in our own format in a separate excel file.

A86. See A12

Q87. Section B" shows quantity 12 but in "8.0 PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE " - Period Of Performance for Base Year, Start Date is 1/1/2026 and end date is 9/30/26. That makes the Quantity 9. Please clarify the Quantity for Item 0001.

A87. See A48.

Q88. Please provide details on how many SQL Server, Oracle, MariaDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL database servers are in the GPO environment. How many are clustered vs standalone. How many are on-premises and how many are in the cloud. Also provide database platform versions.

A88. See A52

Q89. Please provide breakdown on number of databases hosted on SQL Server, Oracle, MariaDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL & MS Access.

A89. 4880 SQL Server Databases across PROD\DEV\Staging\Azure. Oracle – about 10.

Q90. Is it a full time onsite or hybrid contract. If hybrid, what percentage of work can be performed remotely vs. onsite?

A90. See A10, A25

Q91. Who is the current incumbent contractor, what is the contract number, period of performance and total contract value.

A91. See A1, A2

Q92. The place of performance is listed as Remote. Will the government require on site visits or meetings that would require staff to be within a commuting distance to the GPO Central Officer?

A92. While unlikely, that could be possible if necessary. GPO expects virtually all meetings will be held via Teams.

Q93. The solicitation states “Prices shall be firm fixed, for all services and features for each applicable fiscal year within the contract period. Contractors are required to submit their pricing proposal along with the CLIN structure in section B. PRICE/COSTS SCHEDULE. Is it the government intent that offerors provide price information in both a word/pdf file and an excel file (a total of 2 files).

A93. See A12

Q94. For submission of L.5; or the SF1449, should offerors provide this as a standalone file? Or is this a part of Volume II?

A94. Only the signed page SF1449 is required, as part of Volume II.

Q95. Factor 3 states that Offerors share provide 3 PPQs, however Section L states “GPO also accepts CPARs in lieu of the Past Performance Questionnaires”. If an offeror has available CPARS should we provide a copy of the cited CPARS in the place of a PPQ?

A95. Yes.

Q96. Should L.6 be incorporated into Volume II?

A96. Yes.

Q97. Section L states “The Offeror shall provide three (3) list of past performance references with contact information to the Government as part of their proposal.” – Can the government clarify if this mean up to three Past Performance References or a minimum of three Past Performance References?

A97. Offeror shall provide three (3) list of past performance references.

Q98. Could the government confirm that the primary database management system that they are referring is Microsoft SQL Server when they are referring to “SQL”?

A98. Correct. Contractor should be well versed in other SQL databases listed in the solicitation as well, but the primary SQL databases are Microsoft SQL Server.

Q99. Could you please provide an overview of the current database landscape? Specifically, we would appreciate understanding the distribution of database types (e.g., SQL, Oracle, MariaDB, MySQL, and MS Access) across your various environments, including on-premise, AWS, Azure, OCI, or any other cloud platforms. This would also help us clarify whether our team would be expected to support any remaining on-premises database instances, or if all target databases are now hosted in cloud environments.

A99. We manage MSSQL and Azure Databases only. 80% locally and 20% Azure. See A52 and A89.

Q100. Could GPO please provide an estimate of the number of server-based applications they would be supporting? Additionally, for these existing applications, we would be grateful to know the availability of documentation such as Entity Relationship Diagrams (ERDs) or data dictionaries, as this would greatly assist our team in a smooth transition and effective support.

A100. This requirement is for database administrators (SQL & Oracle, .etc). The number of server-based applications is not relevant.

Q101. Could you please clarify whether the scope of work for our DBAs would include the development or maintenance of application programming interfaces (APIs) or data access layers that communicate with the databases, or if their responsibility is primarily focused on advising on database performance for such interfaces.

A101. See A130

Q102. Could you please let us know if GPO is currently utilizing Microsoft Dataverse or other components of the Power Platform that our DBAs would be expected to support?

A102. GPO is currently utilizing Microsoft Power Apps. Support will only be as it relates to Oracle and SQL.

Q103. Could you please provide details on GPO's current backup strategies, retention policies, and Recovery Time Objective (RTO) / Recovery Point Objective (RPO) requirements for all supported databases? Additionally, clarification on whether the contractor will be responsible for executing, monitoring, and validating database backups and restores, or if this function is managed by another entity.

A103. See A58.

Q104. Could you please outline the anticipated frequency and nature of after-hours work for activities such as patching, server reboots, and other server support tasks? Understanding your typical schedule (e.g. quarterly, semi-annually, or an on-call rotation for critical incidents) would be very helpful.

A104. See A43.

Q105. Could you please advise if there is an existing IT Service Management (ITSM) system (e.g., FootPrints, ServiceNow, Jira) that the contractor will be required to use for managing incidents, change requests, and service tickets? Additionally, we would appreciate knowing if GPO has established documentation standards or existing systems (e.g., CMDB, knowledge base) that the contractor will be expected to utilize for documenting changes, configurations, and operational procedures

A105. Contract personnel will have access to ServiceNow tracking system. They will be included in support groups and tickets will be assigned to them directly for action. They will get email notification of any work requests.

Q106. Please clarify whether GPO expects the contractor DBAs to develop ad-hoc business reports or dashboards, or if the scope of work is primarily limited to database administration tasks, such as performance tuning for existing reporting systems?

A106. Database administration tasks and weekly status reports on support activities.

Q107. Could you please share information on the database and server monitoring tools (e.g. cloud native, or specific tools) currently in use that our team would be expected to utilize and potentially contribute to.

A107. See A64

Q108. Could you please confirm the types of sensitive data will be PII, financial, proprietary operational data that our DBAs will be interacting with?

A108. Contractors are vetted via GPO Personnel Security for a public trust clearance which grants them the access to certain PII. They will be required to complete mandatory PII and Privileged User training.

Q109. Could you please confirm whether we are required to submit the Past Performance Questionnaires (PPQs) ourselves, or should our references submit them directly to the Government?

A109. See A22

Q110. How many FTEs does the government anticipate for this requirement?

A110. See A78, A79

Q111. What is the estimated budget for this contract?

A111. Information is not available.

Q112. Can you share the incumbent information and the existing TCV for this requirement?

A112. See A1, A2

Q113. Can the government please confirm whether live resumes for the proposed key personnel are required?

A113. Yes, resumes for the proposed key personnel are required.

Q114. Can the Government provide an approximate breakdown of the current database environment (e.g., number of SQL vs. Oracle instances, versions, database sizes, clustered vs. standalone systems)?

A114. See A89

Q115. Is the Government utilizing any cloud database services (Azure SQL, AWS RDS) currently or planning future migrations? If yes, can you share the roadmap and expected contractor responsibilities?

A115. Yes, however most database activities will be via onsite standalone and VM servers.

Q116. Are DBAs expected to support database security configuration, patching pipelines, vulnerability remediation, or security audit support? If so, what tools or security baselines are used?

A116. Yes, to assist IT Security and IT Infrastructure teams.

Q117. Section C mentions support for SharePoint and other application systems. Can the Government identify other key applications integrated with SQL/Oracle databases?

A117. N/A

Q118. Can the Government clarify the scale and scope of MS Access support? Is this limited to database troubleshooting, or does it include development and modernization support?

A118. MS Access support is minimal and as needed. It will be to support Access databases stood up by customers and modernization support. Not development.

Q119. The RFP notes after-hours support for patching and maintenance. Please confirm the expected frequency (e.g., monthly patch windows, quarterly maintenance cycles).

A119. Monthly OS patch windows are performed by GPO server teams and not the DBAs. SQL and Oracle patching will be coordinated with the server teams and customers and are as needed.

Q120. If a company has organizational past performance managing database administrators/developers of similar scope, but does not itself have five (5) years specifically with SQL and Oracle. If proposed SMEs/Key Personnel each possess the requisite SQL and Oracle experience. Will the Government permit the five-year experience requirement to be satisfied by individual employee/key-personnel qualifications in these technologies, or must it be demonstrated as the Offeror's corporate (organizational) experience?

A120. No. SMEs should have 8+ years of experience across a wide range of database technologies (SQL Server, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, Oracle, etc.).

Q121. Please confirm whether the prime Offeror may rely on identified subcontractors'/teaming partners' corporate experience to meet the minimum five (5) years of required experience including aggregating teammate experience to fill any gap, or whether the prime alone must independently satisfy this threshold.

A121. See A14

Q122. Please confirm that the Government only requires four resumes for the key personnel (SMEs), two senior SQL Server DBAs and two Senior Oracle DBAs, in accordance with Section C, paragraph 4, Task 1, Page 6 of the RFP. There are additional requirements for these roles, and these additional requirements are specified in Section M, Factor#2, pages 15 and 16 of the RFP. The total number of resumes required with the proposal is 4, and you do not require letters of commitment.

A122. Yes, four resumes for the key personnel (SMEs) are required.

Q123. The RFP calls for four full-time DBAs (2 SQL, 2 Oracle) but the pricing section does not specify labor categories or hours. Should Offerors assume 4 FTEs working full time is equivalent to 1,920 hours/year per FTE? May we propose alternative staffing (e.g., blended DBA teams, surge/on-call coverage) if overall coverage and performance objectives are maintained?

A123. See A7, A37

Q124. The evaluation references "realism and reasonableness" for a Firm-Fixed-Price contract. Could GPO clarify how it will evaluate cost realism when no labor hours are specified? Is there an expected level of effort or hours per FTE per year to guide pricing realism?

A124. GPO will evaluate cost based on the proposed GSA rate with applicable discount.

Q125. Given that Factor #2 (SME Qualifications) emphasizes individual experience, could the Government clarify how it will ensure the evaluation of SME qualifications remains focused on technical proficiency and relevant database experience rather than prior access to the incumbent environment, so that all Offerors are evaluated on an equal and competitive basis? Or will SME experience within the incumbent environment be weighted more highly than equal experience within other environments?

A125. No. All Offerors are evaluated on an equal and competitive basis.

Q126. What type of SQL database is the primary database apart from Oracle? The Background statement appears to indicate that there are two types of primary databases. But SQL is the language used to interact with a database (such as Oracle). By SQL do they mean SQL Server?

A126. SQL Server

Q127. What is the estimated number of support tickets per year?

A127. See A55.

Q128. The background indicates that these databases will be installed on a server. Is this a Windows-based, Linux-based or any other type of database server?

A128. Windows

129. How are support requests submitted? Is there a ticketing system currently in place? Or is ticketing ad hoc?

A129. Support requests are submitted by personnel in the affected business area. ServiceNow is currently in place.

Q130. Who is responsible for setting up connections from the applications to the respective databases?

A130. Application owners and DBA's

Q131. What are the compliance requirements with respect to security of these databases?

A131. All DBAs require elevated access via a server administrator account.

Q132. Are there existing configuration documents for the current set of databases?

A132. Yes

Q133. Who is responsible for maintaining the network on which the databases and applications preside?

A133. GPO's Network team.

Q134. What is a common SharePoint issue that relates to database performance that users often face?

A134. N/A

Q135. What are expected to be the top 3 databases maintenance activities that will need to be performed?

A135. Database creation, database management, database server activities (upgrades, etc.).

Q136. What are some examples of support, development and maintenance activities to be performed on the server?

A136. See 135.

Q136. Who is responsible for disaster recovery with respect to these databases?

A136. GPO's infrastructure team in coordination with the DBAs.

Q137. What authentication methods are available to authenticate database users? Are there any special compliance requirements with respect to this?

A137. Authentication methods:

Windows authentication, (AD -integrated)

- SQL server authentication (policy- enforced)
- Azure AD authentication , required for Azure SQL (MFA enforced)

Encryption:

- TDE
- Always Encrypted
- TLS

Yes, we do follow HIPPA compliance requirements.

Q138. Some database maintenance activities will require the databases to be "down". When are these activities expected to be scheduled?

A138. Afterhours (after 5pm or weekends) unless an emergency situation requires work during core business hours.

Q139. Because database administration is a tenet of our larger enterprise solution past performance contracts, we believe emphasis should be placed on the 4 DBA Key Personnel resumes, their expert knowledge and experience, rather than a contract similar in size and scope. Because the GPO is seeking 4 DBA SMEs, will the GPO consider prioritizing evaluation to be most heavily weighted toward the offerors Key Personnel?

A139. Yes.

Q140. PPQs: Given the current government shutdown, and its unknown duration, Offerors cannot be sure that Government personnel, necessary to complete the Past Performance Questionnaires, will be available or able to complete and submit by the current deadline. Would GPO consider extending the deadline for submittal of PPQs?

A140. PPQ must be submitted directly by the offeror as part of the proposal package.

Q141. PPQs: Can the offeror submit past performances that are subcontracts or do all past performances need to be prime contracts?

A141. Subcontracts past performances is acceptable. Please keep in mind that Past performance for projects similar in size and scope to the work described in this RFP may be given more weight in the evaluation.

Q142. Section L.6, all paragraphs, page 15: Are any assumptions/conditions and associated discussion counted against the 30-page limit?

A142. See A96

Q143. Section M.2, Factor #1, bottom of page 15:

a. Please elaborate on what is expected per the last sentence "Successful project should be listed and described with references"—specifically what information is GPO looking for with respect to references.
SQL or Oracle server upgrade

b. Can Corporate Experience examples be different than the Past Performance references provided or does GPO expect them to be the same?
Yes.

c. Do all Corporate Experiences have to cover both SQL and Oracle?
Yes.

Q144. Please elaborate on the statement that "the evaluation will be based on cost/price realism proposed in submitted budgets…" Is this referring to the "project budget" submitted by the Offeror or GPO's own budget submissions to support this requirement?

A144. This referring to the review and evaluation of the Offeror's cost proposal.

Q145. Please describe (in general terms) the importance of price vs the Technical Evaluation is making tradeoff decisions of "best value"—e.g., is Price greater-than, equal to, or less than Technical?

A145. The Government intends to evaluate proposals in accordance with Section M of this RFP. The award will be made to the Offeror representing the best value to meet the Government's needs, which is not necessarily the lowest price.

Q146. Can the Volume II - Price Proposal consist of an XLS only, as long as it's in accordance with Section B?

A146. See A12.

Q147. Section C.9 of the Statement of Work (SOW) states that the work performed is "UNCLASSIFIED and CONFIDENTIAL." Can the Government please clarify the required security clearance or background investigation level for contractor personnel supporting this effort?

A147. See A47.

Q148. The SOW mentions that "after-hours patching or server reboots" may be required but does not specify the expected frequency or compensation approach. Can the Government confirm whether after-hours support activities should be included as part of the Firm-Fixed-Price base effort, or if they will be treated as separately billable tasks?

A148. See A44

Q149. The SOW references "support, development, and maintenance" across multiple database platforms, including SQL Server, Oracle, MariaDB, MySQL, and MS Access. Can the Government provide an approximate number of databases for each platform, along with the operating system environments (e.g., Windows, Linux, Solaris) used for the Oracle, MariaDB, and MySQL databases?

A149. See A89

Q150. What are the citizenship requirements for Personnel?

A150. US citizens or those legally allowed to work in the US (H1B visa holders, Green card holder, etc.).

Q151. Is there free parking available for the on-site office location?

A151. There are paid parking available for badging personnel

Q152. Would the Government consider making this an 8(a) set-aside?

A152. This requirement is unrestricted and not set aside.